

3.2.1 The Tree Of Life Web Project

<http://tolweb.org/tree/phylogeny.html>

The Tree of Life (ToL) represents the collective efforts of a hundred-odd biologists from around the world, and has evolved into something of a bio-wiki. Before starting out on your journey, read the ToL learning guide at <http://tolweb.org/tree/learn/learning.html>. It gives you a look at how the site is organised, and how you need to go about getting the information you desire. You'll also find help under the Help menu at the top of the page.



The Tree of Life is nurtured by hoards of biologists from different countries



The Tree of Life's articles are very well presented

Navigating the site is very wiki-like—you can view the most popular pages, the most recent, or just any old random page. Each article page is loaded with some remarkable imagery, a classification chart, lots of information, and tonnes of references. Throughout the pages, you'll find highlighted words that display a brief definition when you hover the mouse cursor over them. At the top left of the article, you'll see a faint button—click on it to bring up controls that will let you navigate up to the parent group of the article's subject, a subgroup, if any, or sideways within the same group.

One more interesting thing about the ToL is the Treehouse. It's a collection of pages that centres around a particular theme, created by the users themselves. There are very detailed instructions on how to make a Treehouse in the Learning Guide itself—round up a few friends and give it a go!